



characterized by their lustre, colour, and eco-friendly nature. The solid border, woven through a separate mail eye, adds a unique touch to these sarees.

14. Hyderabad Haleem (Telangana)

Hyderabad Haleem, a meat-based stew mostly prepared with mutton, is distinctive for its unique ingredients and specific cooking method. Originating in the Asaf Jahi dynasty era, it is a high-calorie stew consumed during the holy month of Ramzan. Slow-cooked with firewood, it has gained global recognition for its traditional production process and rich, flavourful taste.

15. Nirmal Furniture (Telangana)

Nirmal Furniture, originating from the town of Nirmal in Adilabad, Hyderabad, is crafted from teak wood. Adorned with golden colour floral designs made from gold powder, this furniture reflects a nawabi style of artisanship. The industry, which started in Nirmal and later expanded to Hyderabad, depicts a blend of traditional craftsmanship and a hint of the Nawabs' lifestyle.



IV. Eastern Elegance: Unveiling the Cultural and Natural Treasures through GI Jewels in India's East and North-East

From exquisite textiles to flavourful agricultural produce, the eastern and north-eastern regions of India are home to a rich tapestry of cultures and traditions. Let's explore the diverse GI products that showcase the cultural and natural wealth of India's eastern and north-eastern states:

1. Tezpur Litchi (Assam)

Tezpur Litchi from Assam is a fruit that combines a special size, shape, attractive colour, mouth-watering flavour, and delicious taste. Characterized by ovoid/round shapes, Tezpur Litchi boasts a pleasant flavour, juicy pulp, attractive colour, and a small seed with tight pulp. Rich in energy-giving sugar content and a potent source of vitamin C, Tezpur Litchi also contains potassium, phosphorus, calcium, magnesium, iron, and traces of Vitamin B. This versatile fruit is not only consumed fresh but is also used in the preparation of jelly, squash, sherbet, and nectar, making it a favourite among fruit lovers.

2. Muga Silk of Assam (Assam)

Muga Silk, a purely Assamese creation, derives its name from its golden yellow or brown natural colour. Known for its spun gold appearance, glossy texture, and exceptional durability (lasting over 50 years), Muga Silk holds a special place in the textile industry. The fabric's colour and shine actually intensify with each wash, defying the usual degradation of fabric sheen over time. With the highest tensile strength among natural textile fibres, Muga Silk is comfortable in both summer and winter, believed to have medicinal properties and acid-resistant qualities.

3. Bhagalpuri Zardalu (Bihar)

Bhagalpuri Zardalu is an early to mid-season mango variety, highly sought after for its enticing aroma and creamy, yellow fruits. Named after the dry fruit "Zardalu" due to its similar shape and quality, this mango variety has a historical connection with Maharaja Rahmat Ali Khan Bahadur of Khadakpur, who is believed to have initiated its cultivation in Bihar. With moderately vigorous trees and a rich, creamy texture, Bhagalpuri Zardalu has become a symbol of the region's horticultural prowess.

4. Madhubani Painting (Bihar)

Madhubani Paintings, originating from Bihar, are a captivating form of art with no specific dimension. Carved on various surfaces, including walls, floors, clothes, or craft papers, these decorative paintings abhor empty space. Madhubani art has evolved to adorn saris, bed sheets, curtains, tablecloths, and readymade garments. Divided into three types - wall paintings, line paintings, and Godna paintings (Harijan paintings) - Madhubani art tells stories, imparts visual education, and serves as a form of heritage representation.

5. Kachai Lemon (Manipur)

Kachai Lemon, a high-yielding landrace grown in Kachai village in Ukhrul District of Manipur, is renowned for its distinct aroma, juiciness, and unique flavour. Used for making juice, pickles, and consumed as fresh fruit, Kachai Lemon stands out for its sweet aroma, juicy texture, and different flavour profile. The lemon plants, resembling flowering trees during harvesting time, are not only productive but also add to the visual appeal of the landscape.

6. Shaphee Lanphee (Manipur)

Shaphee Lanphee, a hand-woven fabric shawl crafted by needlework without a frame on a loin loom by Meitei women, holds cultural